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USC Dornsife

Dana and David Dornsife
College of Letters, Arts and Sciences
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Placement Director: Vittorio Bassi, vbassi@usc.edu
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Placement Administrator: Annie Le, anniele@usc.edu

Education

University of Southern California

Ph.D. Economics (expected) 2027

Harvard University

Visiting Ph.D. Student, Department of Economics 2025–2026

Bocconi University

M.Sc. Public Policy and Political Economy 2019

B.Sc. Economics 2016

Fields

Political Economy, Spatial Economics, Applied Microeconomics

References

Thomas Chaney (Chair)	Augustin Bergeron	Jeff Weaver
USC Economics	Harvard Economics	USC Economics
thomas.chaney@usc.edu	abergeon@fas.harvard.edu	jbweaver@usc.edu

Job Market Paper

The Geography of Protests: Spatial Fragmentation, Exposure, and Participation in the George Floyd Movement

Geography is a defining feature of protests: participants travel from their residence to the location of the protest. This paper documents the spatial fragmentation of the George Floyd protests of 2020, which took place simultaneously at multiple venues within the same city. It then studies how this fragmentation shaped the 2020 presidential vote in neighborhoods that received protests and those that sent residents to them. Combining 7,920 geocoded protest events with mobile phone location data, I measure protest participation from each census block group. I then exploit differences in protest exposure and participation within the same zip code to estimate the effect of each on the change in vote shares between the 2016 and 2020 elections. Neighborhoods near protest sites saw increases in Republican vote share, a backlash that decays with distance and is larger near violent protests. Neighborhoods whose residents attended protests saw increased Democratic vote share. The effects coexist: the backlash is large but concentrated in a few neighborhoods, the mobilization small but spread across numerous neighborhoods. Participation moved about 137,000 votes toward the Democrats, while exposure near protest sites cost them about 87,000. Violence cost the movement about half of its potential local gains. The protests' direct local effects are unlikely to have decided the 2020 election.

Work in Progress	Congregations and the Market for Urban Floor Space: Evidence from São Paulo The Dynamics of Protest Fragmentation in the Black Lives Matter Movement	
Awards	Dean's Dissertation Completion Fellowship, USC — \$21,218	2026–2027
	Lusk Center for Real Estate Research Award, USC — \$13,500	2026
	Lusk Center for Real Estate Research Award, USC — \$15,000	2025
	Dan James Fellowship, USC — \$40,000	2024–2025
	Summer Research Award (x4), USC — \$4,000 each	2023–2026
Employment	European Central Bank, Frankfurt, Research Intern	2019
	European Commission, Brussels, Economic Analyst	2017–2018
Research Positions	Research Assistant to Augustin Bergeron, USC	2023
	Research Assistant to Ruben Durante, Pompeu Fabra University	2020–2021
	Research Assistant to Vincenzo Galasso, Bocconi University	2019–2020
Teaching	Teaching Assistant, University of Southern California	Fall 2022–Spring 2024
	<i>Introduction to Econometrics</i> (ECON 318), undergraduate	
	<i>Political Economy and Economic Development</i> (ECON 436), undergraduate	
	<i>Intermediate Macroeconomics</i> (ECON 305), undergraduate	
	<i>Macroeconomic Analysis and Policy</i> (ECON 501), master	
	Teaching Assistant, Bocconi University	2019–2020
	<i>Welfare and Politics</i> , master	
	<i>Economics of European Integration</i> , master	
	<i>Political Economics</i> , undergraduate	
	<i>European Economic Policy</i> , undergraduate	
Presentations	2026: USC Development Seminar, Harvard Graduate Student Workshop in Political Economy 2023–2026: USC Applied Micro Reading Group	
Summer Schools	Summer School in the Economics of Migration, UC Davis	2024
	ACES Summer School in Political Economy, UC Berkeley	2023
Academic Service	Co-organizer, Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics University of Southern California	2023
Research Grants	Weiss Fund Research Grant — \$5,000	2023–2024
Software Skills	Python, R, Stata, MATLAB	
Languages	Italian (native), English (fluent)	
Citizenship	Italian (US F-1 visa)	